(other), Shaukat Afridi, who ran a fleet of NATO tanker trucks, was killed in a bombing during an abortive rescue attempt.'

A Senior Superintendent of Police (SSP) CID Karachi, Ch. Aslam, who was credited with busting several TTP cells in Pakistan's financial hub and was later killed in a suicide attack, said, 'In most of the cases payment of ransom is traced to different parts of the FATA.' He added that the money helped the TTP carry out its militant acts and fund organisational management.

According to the customs officials, a number of customs officials including a superintendent were kidnapped for ransom by the Taliban in 2009. These incidents of kidnapping increased after two officials reportedly paid substantial amounts of money for their release in Peshawar. The released officials were too scared to share with their superiors how they suffered during their incarceration (*The News International*, 2009).

A known ISI operative Col. Tarrar, alias Col. Imam, along with another former ISI official, Squadron Leader (retd) Khawaja Khalid and BBC journalist Asad Qureshi, were apprehended by TTP while travelling in North Waziristan on 26 March 2010. Qureshi was released in September after paying a ransom of Rs 20 million, while Khawaja Khalid and Col. Imam were executed by their captors after the negotiations for ransom and other demands for release of TTP prisoners failed (Butt, 2012).

As the fundings dwindled from other sources in 2011, an increase in high-profile kidnappings for ransom was seen. Three high-profile kidnappings were carried out by TTP elements in Lahore in 2011, which included Amir Malik, son-in-law of Lt. General Tariq Majid; Chairman Joint Chiefs staff committee of the Pakistan Army; Warren Wienstein, a US national working for an NGO and Shahbaz Taseer, son of Salman Taseer, the slain governor of Punjab. The terrorists had been demanding a huge ransom for their release.[9] Amir Malik was released after a year, probably as a result of a deal, which was kept secret. Warren Weinstein was killed in a US drone attack in April 2015. Shahbaz Taseer was released in 2016, the reason for which is still unknown. According to a report, he was released after ransom was paid to his kidnappers; however, it is also said that the captors were on the run due to an attack on them and therefore they abandoned the abductee. An Afghan Taliban activist dropped him near Quetta, from where he called his mother in Lahore.